

Same money, 45% more flat — if the levies hold.

Telford Court's R7,980 unit lands within **R38 a month of SoHo** — a dead heat — for **90 m² against roughly 62**. The catch is that its rent saving is eaten by electricity, and unlike SoHo it has not confirmed what the rent covers.

SOHO R8,800	TELFORD R7,980	TELFORD R8,500	THE SWING FACTOR
R12,504	R12,466	R12,986	R1,300
~62 m² · levies included	90 m² · levies unknown	95 m² · levies unknown	If Telford bills levies on top, SoHo wins

TABLE 1

The three units

WHAT YOU GET			
	SOHO JUNCTION	TELFORD COURT	TELFORD COURT
Advertised rent	R8,800	R7,980	R8,500
Address	4 Poplar Ave Broadacres	Hyperion Rd, off Witkoppen Noordhang, Randburg	
Floor size	not stated sister unit is 62 m²	90 m²	95 m²
Bed / bath	2 / 2	2 / 2 main en-suite, both renovated	2 / 2
Parking	1 carport	1 garage	1 garage + 2 bays
Distance to CRC estimated	~5 km	~6 km — straight run along Witkoppen	
Available	Now	1 Sep	Now 13 July
Facilities	Gym, sauna, steam room, pool, clubhouse, business centre, 24h manned guard	Pool, tennis and squash courts, basketball ring, braai, controlled access	
Fittings	Gas hob, central geyser, LED	Not stated — assumed own geyser and electric stove	
Agency	Match! Property	Rawson Northcliff	Trafalgar

TABLE 2

House costs

No transport. Telford's electricity is estimated at a full-electric load — own geyser, electric stove — because neither listing states otherwise.

MONTHLY HOUSE COSTS			
LINE ITEM	SOHO R8,800	TELFORD R7,980	TELFORD R8,500
Rent	R8,800	R7,980	R8,500
Sanitation, refuse, security	included in rent	unknown — the decisive question	

LINE ITEM	SOHO R8,800	TELFORD R7,980	TELFORD R8,500
Electricity SoHo: central geyser + gas hob · Telford: full electric assumed	R620	R1,200	R1,200
Water SoHo: free 6 kL confirmed · Telford: unconfirmed	R0	R150	R150
Internet 50 Mbps uncapped	R550	R550	R550
House total	R9,970	R9,880	R10,400

WHERE TELFORD'S RENT SAVING GOES

The R7,980 unit is **R820 a month cheaper in rent** than SoHo. But SoHo's geyser sits on the body corporate's account and its hobs are gas, so its electricity runs about **R580 lower** — and its water is free inside 6 kL where Telford's is unknown. By the time you reach the house total the R820 advantage has shrunk to **R90**.

TABLES 3 AND 4

Transport, and the total

TABLE 3 — MONTHLY UBER		
TRIP	SOHO	TELFORD, EITHER UNIT
CRC — one person, 13 round trips	R1,300 R50 each way	R1,352 ~R52 each way, ~6 km
Wits — 2 Wednesdays shared, 2 separate	R1,234	R1,234
Transport	R2,534	R2,586

TABLE 4 — ALL IN			
	SOHO R8,800	TELFORD R7,980	TELFORD R8,500
House	R9,970	R9,880	R10,400
Transport	R2,534	R2,586	R2,586
Monthly total	R12,504	R12,466	R12,986
Gap to SoHo	—	-R38 a dead heat	+R482
The CRC traveller pays	R6,902	R6,909	R7,169
The other person pays	R5,602	R5,557	R5,817
Year one incl. ~R7,450 once-offs	~R157,500	~R157,000	~R163,300

COST PER SQUARE METRE — WHERE TELFORD IS GENUINELY AHEAD			
	SOHO R8,800	TELFORD R7,980	TELFORD R8,500
Floor size	~62 m² assumed from sister unit	90 m²	95 m²
All-in cost per m²	R202	R139	R137

	SOHO R8,800	TELFORD R7,980	TELFORD R8,500
Extra space for the money	—	+45%	+53%

TABLE 5

What decides it

At R38 apart, the base case is meaningless on its own. Everything turns on one unanswered question.

SENSITIVITY — TELFORD R7,980 AGAINST SOHO R8,800			
IF...	TELFORD	SOHO	GAP
Telford's electricity is R900, not R1,200 gas stove or solar geyser	R12,166	R12,504	−R338 — Telford cheaper
Base case — levies included, full-electric	R12,466	R12,504	−R38 dead heat
Telford bills sanitation and refuse on top, at R700	R13,166	R12,504	+R662 — SoHo cheaper
Telford bills them at R1,300 what SoHo's other units charge	R13,766	R12,504	+R1,262 — SoHo clearly cheaper
Either of you joins a gym R650 + ~R1,560 Uber — Planet Fitness is ~9.5 km from Noordhang against 0 at SoHo	R14,676	R12,504	+R2,172 — SoHo much cheaper

THE ASYMMETRY THAT MATTERS

SoHo has answered the levy question; Telford has not. Neither Telford listing states levies, rates, sanitation, refuse or utilities — and both are let by managing agents on behalf of individual landlords, where billing sanitation and refuse to the tenant is common. At SoHo’s own rate that is R1,290–R1,400 a month.

Three of the five rows above put SoHo ahead, and all three turn on charges Telford has not disclosed. That is not a reason to dismiss Telford — it is a reason to make one phone call before deciding.

WHAT TELFORD GENUINELY WINS ON

Space. 90–95 m² against roughly 62 is not a rounding difference — it is a materially bigger flat, and at **R137–139 per m² against R202** it is about a third better value per square metre. The R8,500 unit also has a garage plus two bays where SoHo has one carport.

It is also **on Witkoppen Road**, a straight run to CRC with no cross-suburb navigation, and both units have renovated bathrooms and a main en-suite.

TABLE 6

What to ask Telford

Four questions settle this. The first is worth more than the other three together.

TELFORD COURT – BOTH AGENTS

- 1. **Does the rent cover sanitation, sewerage, refuse and the security levy — or are those billed on top?** Worth up to R1,300 a month. SoHo includes them; if Telford does not, SoHo is cheaper by R662–R1,262 and the comparison is over.
- 2. **Is the geyser electric, gas or solar, and is the stove gas or electric?** The R580 electricity gap between these flats is almost entirely this. A gas stove or solar geyser at Telford would put it R338 ahead of SoHo instead of level.
- 3. Is water metered per unit, and does the free first 6 kL reach the meter?
- 4. What is the deposit, the admin fee, and the annual escalation?
- 5. Is there backup power or water storage? SoHo has none confirmed either — worth asking both.
- 6. How old is the complex, and when were the geyser, plumbing and roof last done? Tennis and squash courts suggest 1980s–90s stock, which usually means more space and more maintenance.
- 7. Confirm the exact street address for the R7,980 unit — the listing withholds the number.

TABLE 7

Assumptions

ASSUMPTION	VALUE	BASIS
Occupancy · gym · transport	Two people · none · Uber	As before
CRC travel	One person, 13 round trips	Mon, Tue, Thu × 4.33 weeks
Wits travel	2.17 shared + 2.17 separate	Your two-and-two pattern over 4.33 Wednesdays
Uber to CRC	R50 SoHo · ~R52 Telford	Your SoHo figure; Telford fitted at ~R39 + R2.25/km over ~6 km
SoHo levies	R0 — in the rent	Confirmed with the agent
SoHo electricity / water	R620 / R0	City Power block 1 at R3.34/kWh over ~185 kWh; free 6 kL confirmed
SoHo floor size	~62 m² assumed	Not stated on the listing. Taken from the sister 2-bed 2-bath in the same complex — confirm, it drives the per-m² figures
Telford levies	R0 assumed	Unconfirmed. Neither listing states them. The single largest uncertainty here
Telford electricity	R1,200	Estimated full-electric load, 300–450 kWh at R3.34. Range R1,000–R1,500
Telford water	R150	Estimated. Unlike SoHo, the metering arrangement is unconfirmed
Telford distance to CRC	~6 km	Estimated from Hyperion Rd, off Witkoppen. Not a measured route
Internet	R550	50 Mbps uncapped. Both are fibre-ready; neither includes it

LISTINGS

- **SoHo Junction, R8,800** — 4 Poplar Ave, Broadacres · 2 bed 2 bath · levies included in rent

- [Telford Court, R7,980](#) — Hyperion St off Witkoppen, Noordhang · 90 m² · 1 garage · available 1 Sep · Rawson Northcliff
- [Telford Court, R8,500](#) — 169 Hyperion Rd, Noordhang · 95 m² · garage + 2 bays · available now · Trafalgar
- [City Power 2026/27 tariffs](#) — Residential Prepaid High block 1 at 290.46 c/kWh excl VAT
- [Johannesburg Water 2026/27](#) — first 6 kL free, R16.45/kL to 10 kL
- [CRC Johannesburg](#) — cnr Witkoppen & Riverbend Road